



Air quality warning in effect for wildfire smoke

August 2, 2026

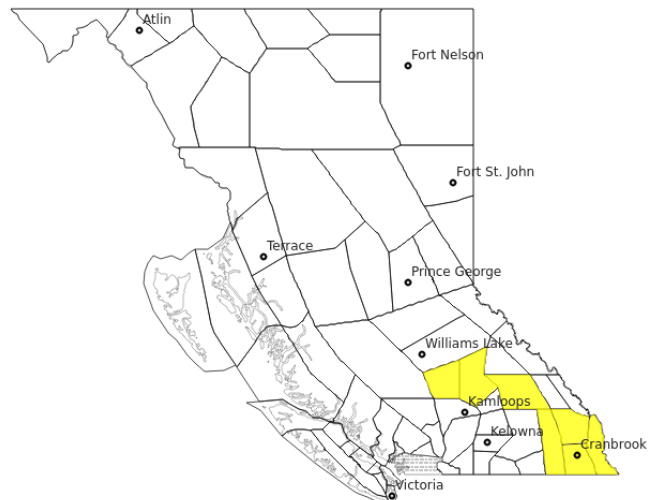
! Yellow Warning - Air Quality

The Regions of BC highlighted on the map are being impacted or are likely to be impacted by wildfire smoke over the next 24-48 hours.

During a wildfire, smoke conditions can change quickly over short distances and can vary considerably hour-by-hour.

Monitor the situation for any wildfires near your area at [EmergencyInfoBC](#). Follow all emergency announcements relevant to your location.

The next update will be available on August 03, 2026 and made available on the Province's [Air Quality Warnings webpage](#).



Actions you can take

Exposure to smoke can affect your health. Postpone or reduce strenuous outdoor activities until the warning has ended. Spend time indoors in a space with cleaner air.

Descriptions of the affected region(s) are provided at the end of this document. This Air Quality Warning excludes the area managed by Metro Vancouver. For air quality notifications issued by Metro Vancouver refer to Metro Vancouver's [air quality data and warnings page](#).

Some people are more likely to be negatively impacted by smoke. This includes people with lung and heart conditions, pregnant individuals, infants and young children, people aged 65 and older, and anyone whose health is affected by a chronic condition or acute illness.

During smoky conditions

Follow your common sense

- Stop or reduce your activity level if breathing becomes uncomfortable or you feel unwell.
- Stay cool and drink plenty of fluids.
- Carry any rescue medications with you at all times.
- Make sure that children and others who cannot care for themselves follow the same advice.

Monitor your symptoms

- Different people have different responses to smoke.
- Mild irritation and discomfort such as eye, nose and throat irritation, phlegm production, runny nose, headaches or mild cough are common, and usually disappear when the smoke clears.
- More serious but less common symptoms include wheezing, chest pains or severe cough.
- People with asthma or other chronic illness should follow any personal care plans designed with their family physicians.
- If you are unsure whether you need medical care, call HealthLink BC at 8-1-1.
- If you are experiencing difficulty in breathing, chest pain or discomfort, or a severe cough, contact your physician, walk-in clinic, or emergency department.
If you are having a medical emergency, call 9-1-1.

Tips to reduce your smoke exposure

- Smoke levels may still be elevated indoors, so stay aware of your symptoms even when you are indoors.
- When indoors, keep windows and doors closed. If it is hot, prioritize keeping cool.
- Protect your indoor air from wildfire smoke. Use a clean, good quality air filter in your ventilation system and/or a certified portable air cleaner that can filter fine particles. Do-it-yourself air cleaners may also be used if other options are unavailable. For more details, see the BC Centre for Disease Control [Do-it Yourself Air Cleaners](#) fact sheet.
- If your home is smoky or hot, spend time in places with cleaner, air conditioned air such as community centres, libraries, or malls.
- If you must be outside, a well-constructed, well-fitting and properly worn respirator type mask (such as a NIOSH-certified N95 or equivalent respirator) can reduce your exposure to the fine particles in the smoke. Even though exposure may be reduced, there can still be risks to health.
- When in a vehicle, keep windows closed with the air flow (or air conditioning) set to recirculate.
- Check on others who are in your care or live nearby who may be more likely to be impacted by wildfire smoke.
- Always follow guidance from local authorities.

More information

For additional information about wildfire smoke and air quality

Air quality notifications issued by Metro Vancouver

- Visit Metro Vancouver's [air quality data and warnings page](#)

Air quality data

- View the latest [Air Quality Health Index \(AQHI\) and forecast](#)
- Visit the provincial [air quality map](#) to view real-time air quality measurements

- Visit aqmap.ca to view real-time low cost sensor measurements

Wildfire smoke forecasts

- Environment and Climate Change Canada smoke forecasts - [FireWork](#)
- BlueSky Canada smoke forecasts - [FireSmoke Canada](#)

For additional general information about wildfire smoke and your health

BC Centre for Disease Control

- Wildfire smoke and its health impacts - [Fact sheets](#)

Provincial Health Authorities

- First Nations Health Authority - [Wildfire smoke health information](#)
- Interior Health Authority - [Steps to prepare for and manage wildfire-related issues](#)

HealthLink BC

- Learn about and prepare for wildfires - [Wildfires and your health resource](#)
- Phone 8-1-1 for 24/7 health advice

Worksafe BC

- Working outdoors during smoky conditions - [Wildfires smoke FAQ](#)

Contact

Media questions regarding air quality conditions related to this Air Quality Warning

Sakshi Jain
Air Quality Meteorologist
Ministry of Environment and Parks
250-420-6435

Media questions regarding health implications of wildfire smoke

First Nations Health Authority
Environmental Public Health Services or Main FNHA Line: 604-693-6500
After Hours: 1-844-666-0711
Email: Ephs.afterhours@fnha.ca
Media line: 604-831-4898

Interior Health Authority
Media line: 1-844-469-7077
Email: media@interiorhealth.ca

Regions included under this Air Quality Warning

- **100 Mile:** includes Hwy 97 from 108 Mile House to Clinton, Bridge Lake and Canim Lake.
- **East Kootenay (North):** includes Edgewater, Invermere, Canal Flats and Skookumchuck.
- **East Kootenay (South):** includes Kimberley, Cranbrook, Yahk, Moyie, Wasa Lake Provincial Park, Jaffray, Grasmere and Roosville.
- **Elk Valley:** includes Elko, Fernie, Sparwood and Elkford.
- **Kootenay Lake:** includes Creston and Kaslo.
- **North Thompson:** includes Barriere, Clearwater and Vavenby.
- **West Columbia:** includes Revelstoke.